

HYPER HISTORY

“LUCY / PILTDOWN MAN”

Two-Column A/V Script

Client Google Arts & Culture
Partner credit Brussels Museum of Natural Sciences
Produced with Vsauce2
Host Kevin (Vsauce2)
TRT 3:12
Aspect 16:9, 1920x1080

VIDEO	AUDIO
Host to camera	KEVIN (SYNC): Hey! Kevin here, from the YouTube science channel, Vsauce2. For years, the question of the MISSING LINK dominated anthropology.
Motion graphic: human evolution sequence	KEVIN (VO): How did we transition from knuckle-scraping apes to bipedal humans?
Hominin reconstruction, full figure. Species title card.	KEVIN (VO): Chances are you may have heard of Lucy, the Australopithecus afarensis discovered in East Africa in 1974.
Host to camera	KEVIN (SYNC): But have you heard of her dubious predecessor: the PILTDOWN MAN? Ready? Here we go.
Illustrated animation: Victorian street life	KEVIN (VO): Set the scene. Victorian London. Powdered wigs. Penny farthings. Walk down the street and you’d hear conversations like this...

VIDEO	AUDIO
Archival period drama: Victorian gentlemen in conversation	VICTORIAN GUY #1 (dubbed VO): Pray tell, have you proffered a gander at Gwendomeer of late?
Archival: Victorian dress detail	VICTORIAN GUY #2 (dubbed VO): Oh yes...
Archival period drama: reverse on second gentleman	VICTORIAN GUY #1: Indubitably. VICTORIAN GUY #2: Quite.
Archival newsreel: newspapers going out	KEVIN (VO): On December 18th, 1912, newspapers around the globe reported a shocking discovery...
Period front page over printing press	KEVIN (VO): ...the MISSING LINK between humans and apes had been found, discovered by scientific genius CHARLES DARWIN.
Portrait of Darwin with name-badge graphic gag	KEVIN (VO): Wait... that can't be right. Ohhhhhh — DAW-SON.
Historical photograph: the Piltdown dig, arrow callout	KEVIN (VO): Amateur archaeologist Charles Dawson found the missing link just outside THE PILTDOWN GOLF CLUB in Sussex.
Period illustration: early hominin in landscape	KEVIN (VO): A human skull, an ape-like jaw. The DAWN MAN was touted as confirmation of Darwin's theory of evolution.
Graphic treatment: the skull repeated in pop-art colourways	KEVIN (VO): Except... it was a fake. It took 30 years to realize that this skull had been doctored.
Archival: excavation and fieldwork	KEVIN (VO): The jawbone weathered to match the gravel. Primate teeth filed down to approximate wear patterns.

VIDEO	AUDIO
Archival portrait over period headline	KEVIN (VO): The question became: who would go to such lengths to create this elaborate hoax? And suspect number one became...
Archival film: Sherlock Holmes, character label	KEVIN (VO): Sherlock Holmes...
Archival: writer at work. Name title card.	KEVIN (VO): ...creator, SIR ARTHUR CONAN DOYLE.
Motion graphic: golf	KEVIN (VO): The famous mystery writer collected fossils in his free time, played golf at Piltdown, and even boasted about how easy it would be to forge a fossil in one of his novels.
Newspaper article scan	KEVIN (VO): He was eventually cleared of suspicion when it was confirmed that Charles Dawson, not Darwin, orchestrated the whole thing.
Vintage cartoon: comic incompetence	KEVIN (VO): Initially, investigators ignored him altogether because he seemed too dimwitted to pull off a hoax of this magnitude. Oops.
Archival: arrest and escort	KEVIN (VO): I guess they were wrong on that one.
Archival: laboratory work	KEVIN (VO): It wasn't until Lucy was discovered in 1974 that the scientific community was able to rid itself of the stink of the Piltdown Man.
Fossil skull on clean background	KEVIN (VO): Lucy was legit. The first omnivorous ancestor of man.
Contemporary: record player	KEVIN (VO): She was discovered while paleoanthropologists were listening to "Lucy in the Sky with Diamonds"...

VIDEO	AUDIO
Hominin reconstruction with VFX gag	KEVIN (VO): ...hence the name Lucy. Pretty groovy, right?
Archival crowd with title card	KEVIN (VO): Lucy was a hugely significant scientific discovery. But the truth is, Lucy isn't the MISSING LINK.
Hands examining a fossil cast	KEVIN (VO): She's not that elusive common ancestor. She isn't the answer we've been searching for.
Archival home movie: open road	KEVIN (VO): But that's... a good thing. That's exciting. Because that's science.
Science macro: neurons firing	KEVIN (VO): Boldly walking toward the dark corners of our understanding. Taking it bit by bit. Step by step.
Archival with animated label callout	KEVIN (VO): It's not about the destination, it's about the ride.
Contemporary: hands at a keyboard	KEVIN (VO): Because if you try and cut the corners on the scientific method, you end up with Piltdown Man.
Sports: the missed shot	KEVIN (VO): And that's no good. Right, Victorian guys?
Callback to the Victorian gentlemen, title treatment	VICTORIAN GUY #1: Indubitably. VICTORIAN GUY #2: Quite.
Vintage "THE END" card	KEVIN (VO): Still curious about Lucy?
Branded end card with CTA buttons	KEVIN (VO): Click here to check out some amazing online installations brought to you by the Brussels Museum of Natural Sciences, proud partners of Google Arts & Culture.

VIDEO	AUDIO
End card holds	KEVIN (VO): And for more amazing videos like this, be sure to subscribe to the Google Arts & Culture channel by clicking right here. Thanks.
